NAME

nylex − word processor in the style of LEX

SYNOPSIS

nylex [**−f** *system.vmf*] [**−u** *terminal*] [**−w** *workfile*] [**−c swe7**|**latin1**|**utf8**] [*document*]
nylex /F*system.vmf* **/U***terminal* **/W***workfile* *//keys//*

DESCRIPTION

Nylex is a word processor made in the image of LEX, the word processor of Ace Microsystems Ltd (written in its Filetab-D language), which DIAD AB sold in Sweden as LEX-68 for DIAB's D-NIX machines. It was written from scratch for the D-NIX Amiga port after LEX's technical manual (version 9, 1985); none of LEX's code is in it. It reads and writes LEX's documents and its system files, LEX-68's own **lex9a1.vmf** among them, and works as the manual describes: a screen editor driven by keystrokes, and programs of keystrokes (in keystores and in the records of the system file) that make up menus, forms, list processing and mailshot.

Without a *document nylex* starts with the first menu (****MENU**). A character picks a line of a menu; ESC E or Ctrl U goes back a menu, and leaves the first one. At a menu, / and a menu switch option (see below) can be typed too. With a *document nylex* goes straight to editing it.

Documents are text files in the current directory, named in lower case (**BREV.BRV** is the file **brev.brv**; a name without a dot gets the default type, **.BRV** in nylex's own system file). NAME/*.EXT uses the details of another document type. A document starts with a ruler, a line of ruler characters across the screen:

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F.....................................................................M
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F where paragraphs start, with a ragged right margin (J: justified), M the right margin, L tab stops, R right-aligned tab stops, T tab stops not used in insert mode, C centring (to M), H the hyphenation zone, and **####,###.##** a numeric field (Tab into it starts the calculator). A tab stop between F and M indents the first line of a paragraph. Each ruler holds for the text under it. Saving keeps the previous version as *name*.BAK (the backup type of ****INST**). Attributes (underline, bold ...) are kept as LEX keeps them: the line ends in the character 255 and the next line holds the attributes.

The system file (.VMF, 512-byte blocks of keyed records) holds the menus, help pages, forms, printers, messages, rulers and abbreviations of each document type, dictionaries and output formats for list processing, data records, and the document index: for each document its title and description, the dates it was made, changed, read and printed and how many times, the time spent on it, and its lines, words and characters. By default it is **$HOME/nylex.vmf**, copied the first time from one that comes with *nylex*: **nylex.vmf** in Swedish when the locale is Swedish (**$LC_ALL, $LC_MESSAGES** or **$LANG** starts with **sv** or names **_SE**), else **nylex-en.vmf** in English (on the D-NIX Amiga port, without a locale, Swedish). A system file named with **−f** that is not there yet is copied from the one of that name, if there is one (**nylex −f nylex-en.vmf**). The work file (**$HOME/nylex.wrk**) keeps the keystores, rulers 6-9, the cut buffers, the search strings and the calculator's memories from one session to the next.

MENU SWITCH OPTIONS

Column 1 of a menu line says what the line does, columns 2-11 name a record for it; typed at a menu as /x they ask for what they need.

C E I V	make, change, change (first line), view a document
K R A J	delete documents, rename, copy and edit, copy
P Q	print a document, several copies
X	the playground, running the record named (a program)
M U	another menu; another terminal record (**)NAME**)
S L	list processing with an output format; mailshot with a document
F Z G	another system file; another work file; leave for a program
1 2	another **MONT, **INST or **PNST; clear the work file

T W statistics of the system file; the state of nylex

0 3 4 unlock records; reorganise the system file; copy records between system files

6 convert a document with *CONV

B D H N
run a program (the record's first 32 characters) on documents

CONTROL KEYS

Ctrl U J H R	up, down, left, right (the arrow keys too)
Ctrl F, Ctrl B	next word, word before
Ctrl G	end of the line
Ctrl L, Ctrl T	a screen forward, back (Page Down, Page Up)
Ctrl Q, Ctrl S	top, end of the document
Return, Tab	start of the next line; next tab stop (aligning text typed after C and R stops, the calculator in # fields)
Ctrl A, Ctrl X	a blank line in, the line out
Ctrl D, Ctrl P	the character out (P: the paragraph closes up)
Ctrl E, Ctrl N	a blank in (N: the paragraph moves on)
Ctrl W, Ctrl V	the word, the rest of the line out
Rubout	the character to the left out
Ctrl Y	the character above copied
Ctrl K	the word changes case
Ctrl O, Ctrl Z	save and leave; leave without saving
Ctrl C	stop a program

ESCAPE SEQUENCES

ESC is pressed and let go before the next key.

ESC E, ESC Z	save and leave; leave without saving
ESC V, ESC Q X	save and start again; the same, at the same line
ESC I, ESC - I	insert mode on, off
ESC J, ESC Q J	justify the paragraph; from the cursor
ESC Return, ESC Ctrl J	to the left margin of the next line; split the paragraph
ESC \, ESC - \	vertical typing on, off
ESC @, ESC #, ESC &	centre, right-align between tab stops; wide line
ESC M n, ESC W n, ESC U n	ruler n put in; the line stored as ruler n; ruler n used
ESC S G, ESC - S G	ignore the rulers in the document, use them again
ESC S (n, ESC < n	mark position n; go back to it
ESC Q A, ESC Q B	copy the line above, below
ESC Q E, ESC Q M	end, top of the document
ESC Q F, ESC Q G	next paragraph, paragraph before

ESC Q K, ESC Q L — start of the line; the last character on the screen

ESC Q U, ESC Q V — end of the last word, of the next word

ESC Q H, ESC Q I — hyphenate; show the hyphenation

ESC (, ESC) x L|B|S
: mark; cut to buffer x (main, T-Z, or keystore 0-9): leave, blank, squeeze (both ends in column 1: whole lines)

ESC . x L|B|S — the same for sentences

ESC * x E|I|O|D — paste: elbow, insert, overlay; empty the buffer

ESC } E|I|O — paste blanks

ESC - D, ESC - W, ESC - X
: the last character, word, line taken out comes back

ESC F, ESC G, ESC - G
: find, get (search forward), search back: the string ended by Return ignores case and blanks, by Line feed it is exact; a/b, a&b and a\n search for either, both on a screen, a in column n

ESC X n|0|W|U — repeat what follows n times, to the end, while, until

ESC = — repeat the last escape sequence

ESC A n, ESC B n — attribute n (1-5) on, off; ESC B L, ESC B W to the end of the line, the next word; ESC B T, ESC B U show them

ESC B A|D, ESC B H|V A|D
: sort lines; sort columns

ESC K, ESC T, ESC Y, ESC Q N
: the date as yymmdd, short, in full; the time

ESC + — the calculator (Appendix D of LEX's manual: + - * / % = ( ) Q, P n, K S x, K U, C, Z, F, I, N, S A R E x memories 0-9 A-Z, H V totals)

ESC S n, ESC n — give keystore n a text (to Return); type keystore n

ESC R n, ESC R S, ESC R C
: the last keystrokes into keystore n; typed again; forgotten

ESC P — page break where the printing details put it

ESC L, ESC H — the status line; the last error explained

ESC S L, ESC S W, ESC S E
: status line, page warning, errors shown (ESC - S ... off)

ESC M O|M|C|I|E|S|V|A|J|U
: merge a document: open, all, close, a line, to the end, selected lines, view, advance, skip, until

ESC W O|C|E|X|J|U — extract to a document

ESC O O|F|X — open a document from the playground

ESC C A|B|F|P — clear to the end; the background, the foreground of the screen; the protected area

ESC C D — other document details (type)

ESC R D|N|M|O|V|W|I|G
: type the document name, its key, the VMF name, the menu option, the terminal record, the work file; show the system records, the merge file

ESC Q S, ESC Q T, ESC Q W
: run a program: named in a record; asked for, waiting; asked for

RECORDS AND PROGRAMS

In a program (a record performed, a keystore) the characters of ****MONT** stand for keys; in the Swedish one (and : are the start and end keys < and >, $ ESC, ’ Ctrl, ; Return, @ the next character as it is, "..." a comment, ! or ? a pause until Return. Typing <KEY> performs the record KEY (<KEY+n/m> types characters n to n+m-1 of it).

ESC > R|C|U|P|A|K
: read, create, update, put (create or update), add to, kill the record whose key follows the start key on the line (ESC] ... with the implicit returns)

ESC N, ESC - N, ESC Q Y
: the next, previous key; the next deleted one

ESC S P, ESC U P
: protect mode: only the fields (paint characters) can be typed in; a record read or written is the fields in order, up to the cursor

ESC S B, ESC U B
: background mode (typed text is protected)

ESC S H, ESC S U
: shush, shut-up mode (ESC - S H, ESC - S U off)

ESC S M, ESC U M
: mask on, off; ESC S F, ESC U F a foreign system file; ESC S Q x the squash character

ESC C T x
: conditional: S string, K key, D document, F foreign key, N number at the cursor, Q question, + - 0 accumulator; then two programs ended by Return

ESC R K
: perform a record named at a prompt

LIST PROCESSING

An output format (a record) names a dictionary, P or V and the lines per page, the record type, and options (/A /D sort, /T totals, /H help, /P paint, /S spacing, /C print characters, /F foreign file, /U mark); then headings, a blank line and the detail lines, where fields are written with their formatting characters or as (NAME: in Swedish. At the select prompt: NAME=value, >, <, : (contains), a-b, OCH, ELLER, INTE, HELP; /K/K deletes what is selected. Mailshot puts the fields of each record into a document.

PRINTING

****PNST** asks which printer; each has a type (*$ escape sequences, *% for combinations of attributes), a code table (*#, *(functions), and a device or command. In the document: .C print characters, .T titles, .F footers (**(SIDA:** or, in English, **(PAGE:** is the page number), .N footnotes, .P .PP page breaks, .S spacing, another document, .X a program.

A printer of the type **PDF**, **PDFSANS** or **PDFMONO** (printer 7 in the system files that come with *nylex*; it asks for the file’s name) makes a PDF document instead, in Times, Helvetica or Courier; one of the type **PS**, **PSSANS** or **PSMONO** (printer 9, through lp) the same in PostScript, for a PostScript printer or a file. Courier keeps LEX’s 10 characters to the inch. In Times and Helvetica the text is set proportionally, as a daisy-wheel printer with a proportional wheel set it: the lines of a justified paragraph (J ruler) are spread to the margin, the other text starts at its columns (12 to the inch, which these fonts about fill), numbers end at theirs, and lines centred or against M stay so. Attributes 1 and 4 underline, 2 and 5 are bold, 3 italic; footnote numbers are raised. The page is A4 (US Letter with **LEXPAPER=letter**), 6 lines to the inch.

A daisy-wheel printer with a proportional wheel prints the same way when its code table (*#) names a proportional spacing record **;***NAME* (LEX-68’s kind): for each character 32-126 the increments of 1/120 inch to move before and after printing it, and at character 191 the wheel’s own petal table. The printer is driven with Diablo 630’s motion index (ESC US n), which most daisy-wheel printers understand. Printer 8 in the system files that come with *nylex* is such a printer (***$DIABLO**, the made-up wheel **;PS10**); the form ***PSFORM** (in the forms menu) shows and changes a wheel’s record.

OPTIONS

−f *file*, **/F***file*
: the system file (also **$LEXVMF**).

−u *name*, **/U***name*
: the terminal record **)***name* (also **$LEXVDU**; VT100 terminals need none).

−w *file*, **/W***file*
: the work file (also **$LEXWORK**).

//keys// keys typed ahead, as a program.

−c swe7|**latin1**|**utf8**
: how the terminal shows the Swedish letters. Documents keep them as LEX did, in 7-bit Swedish (ISO 646-SE: [\ ] { | } are the letters A-umlaut, O-umlaut, A-ring and their lower case). With an English system file (its ****MONT** has English hyphenation) [\ ] { | } are themselves, and the letters of Latin-1 are kept as they are. **swe7** switches the terminal to 7-bit Swedish (on the D-NIX Amiga console), **latin1** (the default) and **utf8** (the default when the locale says UTF-8) translate.

−V the version.

ENVIRONMENT

LEXVMF, LEXVDU, LEXWORK as above; LEXPRINT, a command that takes all printing (instead of the printer of ****PNST**); LEXPAPER (**a4** or **letter**) and LEXPDF (the column and the size of the font of a PDF, in points: **7.2,15**) for PDF printers.

FILES

$HOME/nylex.vmf, $HOME/nylex.wrk
: the system file, the work file

/usr/local/share/nylex/nylex.vmf, nylex-en.vmf
: the system files that come with *nylex*, in Swedish and in English (on the D-NIX Amiga port in /usr/modern/lib/nylex, and the source is in /usr/modern/src/nylex)

/usr/local/share/nylex/*.dict
: the dictionaries of *lexspell*(1)

/usr/local/share/doc/nylex/TUTORIAL.md
: a first tour of nylex, step by step

SEE ALSO

lexvmf(1), lexspell(1), lexconv(1). On the D-NIX Amiga port, lex68 runs LEX-68 itself as a demonstration version.

NOTES

The system files that come with *nylex* are its own, in Swedish and in English: menus, help pages, forms for the installation, the printers, the document types and the printer codes, the document index, an address register with lists, labels and circular letters, an export and import (X in the document menu) that runs *lexconv*(1) for RTF, Word, OpenDocument, Markdown, HTML and text, and a spelling menu that runs *lexspell*(1) with a Swedish or a British English dictionary (the records ***=SPLDEF**x; put en-US at character 33 for American English). The English one uses the keys of the manual's German/Scandinavian table (< and > start and end a key; (: ; in programs) rather than those of its English example ([ ] and \), so that brackets can be typed; an English ****MONT** that starts 091 works as the manual says. With LEX-68's **lex9a1.vmf** its own menus, forms and programs run instead.